

EXCURSION RISK MANAGEMENT TEMPLATE

WATER-BASED EXCURSION RISK MANAGEMENT

Victorian Secondary Schools · Aligned to DE Excursion Policy
Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy

SCHOOL

DATE OF EXCURSION

YEAR LEVEL(S)

Important — Please Read Before Use

This template is designed to support compliance with Department of Education policy for water-based excursions in Victorian secondary schools. Always verify current requirements against the DE Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy and DE Excursions Policy before finalising and submitting this document.

DE Swimming Policy: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy · DE Excursions Policy: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/excursions/policy

A Excursion Details

School Name	Excursion Title	
Date(s) of Excursion	Year Level(s)	Number of Students
Venue / Location Name	Full Street Address (for 000 purposes)	
Teacher in Charge (TIC)	TIC Mobile Number	Venue Emergency Contact

Water Activity Type (tick)	Water Environment (tick)	Patrolled venue?
Beach swim · Pool swim · Kayaking Snorkelling · River · Other: _____	Patrolled beach · Unpatrolled beach Pool · River · Dam · Lake · Other	Yes — lifeguard provided No — school provides supervision

B Supervision Arrangements

Always verify current DE supervision ratios at: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

Role	Name	Qualification / Cert.	Contact on the day
Teacher in Charge (TIC)			
Supervising Teacher 2			
Supervising Teacher / Adult 3			
Lifeguard / Instructor (venue)		Current lifeguard cert.	
Designated Water Watcher		Role: scan water continuously. No other tasks. Rotate every 15–20 min.	
First Aider on site		Current first aid cert.	

Total supervising adults Student : adult ratio Ratio meets DE requirement? (circle: Yes / No
— if No, escalate to principal)

C Student Information & Medical Considerations

Consideration	Number / Detail	Management Strategy
Non-swimmers		Coloured cap identification. Shallow-end / shore supervision only. Buddy assigned. All supervisors briefed.
Weak / beginner swimmers		Identified with coloured caps or wristbands. Restricted to waist-depth. Water Watcher priority monitoring.
Students with asthma		Inhaler location confirmed. TIC briefed. Avoid cold water entry stress. Spare inhaler at first aid station.
Students with cardiac conditions		Medical clearance confirmed. AED location known. Cold water entry monitored. TIC briefed.
Students with epilepsy		Buddy assigned at all times in water. Lifeguard briefed. Emergency protocol confirmed.
Other conditions		
Consent forms received		All forms on file at school office and copy with TIC. Students without consent cannot participate in water activities.

Students with specific restrictions (list by name and restriction):

D Hazard Register & Risk Controls

■ HIGH — eliminate or substitute before proceeding ■ MEDIUM — control required, document mitigation ■ LOW — monitor and manage

Likelihood × Consequence: 1=Negligible, 5=Catastrophic

Hazard	Likelihood (1–5)	Consequence (1–5)	Risk Level	Control Measures in Place
Drowning / near-drowning		5	HIGH	Patrolled venue OR qualified lifeguard on deck; Water Watcher assigned; non-swimmers identified; buddy system; all supervisors CPR trained; AED accessible.
Cold water shock (inland / open water)		4	MEDIUM	Water temperature assessed pre-excursion (do not proceed below 15°C for school groups). Students enter gradually. Cold water shock briefing delivered. First aider on site.
Rip currents (beach venues)		5	HIGH	Patrolled beach between flags only. Students briefed on rip identification and escape. BeachSafe conditions checked morning of excursion. No unpatrolled beach entry permitted.
Watercraft collision (kayaking / paddling)		4	MEDIUM	Lifejackets (PFDs) worn at all times on water. Paddle Australia safety briefing delivered. Designated launch and exit zones. No paddling in vessel traffic areas.
Slip / fall on wet surfaces		3	MEDIUM	No running on pool deck / jetty. Non-slip footwear required at pool venues. Students briefed on walk-only rules. Wet surfaces inspected pre-session.

Hazard	Likelihood (1–5)	Consequence (1–5)	Risk Level	Control Measures in Place
Diving into unknown / shallow water		5	HIGH	Feet-first entry rule enforced at all venues. Depth posted at all entry points. "No diving" instruction given at start. Zero tolerance enforced.
Sunburn / heat stress (outdoor venues)		2	LOW	Sunscreen applied pre-activity. Hats and rashvests available. Shade access during non-swimming time. Hydration encouraged. Heat plan if >35°C.
Marine stingers (beach venues)				Check SLISA / BeachSafe for marine life alerts. Purple flag = do not enter. Vinegar at first aid station (jellyfish stings). Review conditions day-of.
Missing student		4	MEDIUM	Buddy system in place. Head counts every 10 minutes. Designated meeting point communicated to all students. Check-in / out protocol at all entries and exits.
Medical emergency (non-drowning)			MEDIUM	First aid kit on site. Trained first aider present. 000 protocol: venue address confirmed before departure. Nearest hospital / medical centre identified.
Additional hazard (site-specific):				
Additional hazard (site-specific):				

E Emergency Procedures

Emergency Type	Procedure
Drowning / near-drowning	1. Signal lifeguard immediately (whistle / shout). 2. Call 000 — state venue address. 3. Clear all other students from water. 4. Begin DRS ABCD. 5. Send person to entrance to direct ambulance. 6. Notify school administration. 7. Document time, observations, and actions taken.
Missing student	1. Immediate head count. 2. Assign adults to search zones. 3. One supervisor stays with remaining students. 4. If not located within 5 minutes: call 000 and notify principal immediately. 5. Do not leave venue.
Serious injury (non-drowning)	1. Assess danger. 2. Call 000 if life-threatening. 3. Apply first aid — do not move casualty unless in danger. 4. Notify school administration. 5. Contact parent / carer. 6. Complete incident report same day.
Medical emergency (anaphylaxis / cardiac)	1. Call 000 immediately. 2. Administer EpiPen if anaphylaxis and student is prescribed one. 3. Use AED if unresponsive and pulseless (AED location: _____). 4. Begin CPR (30:2) if not breathing. 5. Stay with student until ambulance arrives.
Severe weather / lightning	1. Clear water immediately at first thunder or lightning sighting. 2. Move all students to designated shelter: _____. 3. Do not re-enter water until 30 minutes after last lightning. 4. If shelter unavailable, remain in vehicles or low-lying area away from trees.

Venue address for 000:

Nearest hospital:

School Principal mobile:

F Pre-Excursion Compliance Checklist

- ☐ DE Excursion Policy reviewed and current version confirmed
- ☐ Principal approval obtained and documented
- ☐ All student consent forms collected and on file
- ☐ All student medical forms reviewed — restrictions and conditions noted in Part C
- ☐ Supervision ratios confirmed to meet DE requirements (Part B)
- ☐ Qualified lifeguard confirmed for venue (or school providing equivalent qualified supervision)
- ☐ Designated Water Watcher role assigned and briefed on duties and rotation schedule
- ☐ First aid kit checked and stocked; first aider qualified and present on the day
- ☐ AED location at venue confirmed and operational — test before departure
- ☐ Venue address confirmed for 000 purposes — written on TIC's phone or paper card
- ☐ Nearest hospital or medical centre confirmed and route known
- ☐ Non-swimmers and restricted swimmers identified and all supervisors informed
- ☐ Coloured caps or wristbands arranged to identify non-swimmers and beginner swimmers
- ☐ Students have received water safety briefing (use Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing sheet)
- ☐ Student safety acknowledgement forms signed and collected
- ☐ Weather forecast checked — proceed / no-proceed criteria confirmed
- ☐ BeachSafe / venue conditions checked morning of excursion (beach venues)
- ☐ Lifejackets (PFDs) available, fitted, and inspected (kayaking / paddling excursions)
- ☐ Transport arrangements confirmed — bus / vehicle supervision included
- ☐ Complete copy of this risk management document provided to school administration before departure

G Conditions for Proceeding & Contingency Plan

Condition	Proceed Threshold	Contingency if Threshold Not Met
Weather	No thunder / lightning forecast. Wind below 30 km/h for water activities. Temp above 15°C for open water.	Classroom-based water safety theory lesson (use student workbooks). Reschedule within term.
Surf / water conditions (beach)	Patrolled beach conditions acceptable to lifeguard on duty. No red-only flag. No rip current active in swimming zone.	Move to alternative patrolled beach confirmed in advance, or substitute pool activity. Do not proceed at unpatrolled beach.
Supervision ratios	Full required supervision ratio met. Lifeguard confirmed on site before departure.	Do not proceed without required adult ratios. Contact school for relief staff. Reschedule if unresolvable.
Venue availability	Venue confirmed open, lifeguard on duty, and water quality acceptable on the day.	Backup venue: _____ (confirm in advance of excursion date)
Water temperature (inland venues)	Water temperature at or above 15°C. Below this threshold triggers cold water shock risk for school groups.	Substitute pool-based activity. Do not enter cold open water with a school group. Document decision.

Backup / contingency activity if excursion cannot proceed:

H Approval & Sign-Off

Teacher in Charge

Signature:

Date approved:

Assistant Principal / Year Level
Coordinator

Signature:

Date approved:

Principal — Final Approval

Signature:

Date approved:

Post-excursion notes / incident record (complete within 24 hours of return):

Policy References — Always verify current requirements before use

DE Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

DE Excursions Policy: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/excursions/policy

Life Saving Victoria: lsv.com.au · Paddle Australia (kayaking / paddling): paddle.org.au · BeachSafe (conditions): beachsafe.org.au

Template Version: 2026 · Swim & Water Safety HPE Unit · Created by Emilie Harrison · swimwater.safety@gmail.com